

Zeph Norwood

Character Dossier

Warm, nosy and impossible to offend cartographer of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border

Overview

Zeph Norwood is a cartographer living in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border. Zeph is 50 years old, originally from Caldera Row, and is known around the east rampart as warm, nosy and impossible to offend. In conversation Zeph uses trade jargon and then patiently explains it.

Background

Zeph arrived in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border 11 years ago after leaving Caldera Row under circumstances Zeph describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Frostwall Legion; the second was the one that stuck. Today Zeph works as a cartographer near the quartermaster's stores and is paid, when paid at all, in iron pennies.

Zeph learned the trade from Ysolde Duskmere, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Zeph's life is with Tomasz Blackwater, over a matter neither will explain. The person Zeph trusts most is Vesna Corvane.

Current goal: to map every path through the east rampart. Greatest fear: the bells at midnight.

Personality and speech

Temperament: warm, nosy and impossible to offend.

Speech pattern: Zeph uses trade jargon and then patiently explains it.

Tells: when lying, Zeph mentions Bellows the beetle for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Zeph Norwood
<i>Role</i>	cartographer
<i>Home</i>	the Frostwall garrison on the northern border
<i>Hometown</i>	Caldera Row
<i>Age</i>	50
<i>Favourite dish</i>	midnight seaweed crackers
<i>Pet</i>	Bellows, a beetle
<i>Lucky number</i>	421

<i>Workshop password</i>	copper-velvet
<i>Mentor</i>	Ysolde Duskmere
<i>Rival</i>	Tomasz Blackwater
<i>Closest friend</i>	Vesna Corvane

Secret

Zeph writes poetry under the pen name 'The Copper' and has a small, devoted readership.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Zeph: I am the cartographer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Zeph: Midnight seaweed crackers. Do not tell Tomasz I said so.

Visitor: Is Bellows yours?

Zeph: Bellows belongs to nobody. Bellows tolerates me. Lucky number is 421, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 4

Rumours about the comet reached the east rampart. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zeph won 38 iron pennies on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on supper. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zeph was hired to carry a signal flag from the east rampart to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 2, summer of year 4

Zelda came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zeph repaired the spool of wire at the quartermaster's stores for Ignatius, who paid in 57 iron pennies and a long story about the comet. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 51 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 3, winter of year 4

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zeph was hired to carry a ledger from the mess hall to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Zeph found a bolt of linen half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 4, winter of year 4

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the east rampart: 64 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. At the east rampart, Zeph taught a newcomer how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph found a iron kettle half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 5, winter of year 4

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 41 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short. Zeph won 67 iron pennies on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on supper. Zeph repaired the brass lantern at the frozen moat for Viggo, who paid in 10 iron pennies and a long story about the singing at the docks. Zeph found a oilskin map half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zeph found a bundle of letters half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 6, spring of year 4

Zeph closed early, walked to the east rampart, and watched the lights come on. The weather turned. Zeph moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the old tunnels. Zeph found a sextant half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 7, spring of year 4

Zeph closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. Zeph found a bundle of letters half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the new curfew flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph found a bundle of letters half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 8, spring of year 4

Zeph won 8 iron pennies on a bet about the census and spent all of it on supper. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 16 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Zeph was hired to carry a sextant from the signal tower to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Zeph won 32 iron pennies on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 9, summer of year 5

Zeph found a bolt of linen half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zeph repaired the signal flag at the frozen moat for Anouk, who paid in 75 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 71 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 10, spring of year 5

Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Zeph has a suspect and is probably right. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph repaired the wax seal at the quartermaster's stores for Dashiell, who paid in 38 iron pennies and a long story about the rumour of a second well. Zeph repaired the brass lantern at the quartermaster's stores for Astrid, who paid in 53 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels.

Entry 11, winter of year 5

Zeph closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph found a grain scale half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 12, autumn of year 5

The weather turned. Zeph moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the price of lamp oil. Rumours about the comet reached the east rampart. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zeph closed early, walked to the frozen moat, and watched the lights come on. Zeph repaired the pair of spectacles at the east rampart for Ravi, who paid in 34 iron pennies and a long story about the new curfew.

Entry 13, summer of year 6

Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the signal tower. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Zeph moved the tin whistle indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 50 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short.

Entry 14, spring of year 6

Zeph repaired the bundle of letters at the east rampart for Olwen, who paid in 73 iron pennies and a long story about the singing at the docks. Zeph won 27 iron pennies on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper. Zeph found a glass float half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 15, spring of year 6

At the mess hall, Zeph taught a newcomer how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. At the mess hall, Zeph taught a newcomer how to tell a real sack of salt from a fake one by weight alone. Marisol came by asking about the singing at the docks. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 16, summer of year 6

Zeph found a tin whistle half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. At the east rampart, Zeph taught a newcomer how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone. At the east rampart, Zeph taught a newcomer how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 17, summer of year 6

Zeph was hired to carry a ledger from the quartermaster's stores to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 36 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Zeph closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 18, autumn of year 6

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them

conceding.

Entry 19, summer of year 6

Zeph won 24 iron pennies on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on supper. Zeph closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. At the mess hall, Zeph taught a newcomer how to tell a real bolt of linen from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph was hired to carry a sextant from the mess hall to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the quarantine reached the mess hall. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 20, spring of year 6

A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the quarantine reached the mess hall. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 21, spring of year 6

Zeph closed early, walked to the mess hall, and watched the lights come on. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the missing shipment. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zeph repaired the signal flag at the frozen moat for Brigid, who paid in 74 iron pennies and a long story about the rumour of a second well.

Entry 22, winter of year 6

Zeph repaired the brass lantern at the frozen moat for Nkechi, who paid in 19 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment. At the frozen moat, Zeph taught a newcomer how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph found a ledger half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 23, spring of year 6

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 57 of everything, except the signal flag, which is always short. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Zeph has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 24, summer of year 6

Zeph found a hand bell half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zeph won 83 iron pennies on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on supper. The weather turned. Zeph moved the grain scale indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about who really won the regatta. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 25, winter of year 7

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 71 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zeph was hired to carry a tin whistle from the quartermaster's stores to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 26, winter of year 7

A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Zeph found a cracked compass half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zeph won 23 iron pennies on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 27, summer of year 7

A dispute over the tax on doors flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the signal tower. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Zeph moved the oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the new curfew.

Entry 28, winter of year 7

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the mess hall. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the census flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the mess hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 29, summer of year 7

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 48 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short. At the signal tower, Zeph taught a newcomer how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph repaired the tin whistle at the signal tower for Greta, who paid in 86 iron pennies and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Zeph was hired to carry a sextant from the signal tower to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 30, summer of year 7

Rosalind came by asking about the missing shipment. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zeph was hired to carry a oilskin map from the frozen moat to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Zeph has a suspect and is probably right. Zeph was hired to carry a copper pipe from the frozen moat to the signal tower without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the census flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 31, autumn of year 7

Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Zeph has a suspect and is probably right. Zeph was hired to carry a glass float from the east rampart to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly

succeeded. Zeph was hired to carry a sack of salt from the east rampart to the frozen moat without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a coil of rope on the doorstep with no note. Zeph has a suspect and is probably right. Rumours about the comet reached the east rampart. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 32, autumn of year 7

The weather turned. Zeph moved the copper pipe indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the harvest count. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zeph repaired the spool of wire at the mess hall for Winifred, who paid in 90 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment.

Entry 33, autumn of year 8

Zeph found a tin whistle half-buried near the east rampart and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zeph repaired the sack of salt at the east rampart for Tomasz, who paid in 37 iron pennies and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Zubair came by asking about the old tunnels. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 34, autumn of year 8

Zeph repaired the hand bell at the signal tower for Wendeline, who paid in 51 iron pennies and a long story about the quarantine. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zeph repaired the brass lantern at the signal tower for Dorothea, who paid in 79 iron pennies and a long story about whether the bridge will hold.

Entry 35, autumn of year 8

The weather turned. Zeph moved the copper pipe indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the missing shipment. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph won 21 iron pennies on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on supper. Wendeline came by asking about the census. Zeph said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 36, autumn of year 8

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the signal tower: 35 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. The weather turned. Zeph moved the glass float indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the price of lamp oil. Zeph repaired the brass lantern at the signal tower for Sable, who paid in 68 iron pennies and a long story about the old tunnels. Zeph found a iron kettle half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 37, spring of year 9

Zeph was hired to carry a ledger from the mess hall to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Zeph has a suspect

and is probably right. At the mess hall, Zeph taught a newcomer how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone. Zeph repaired the tin whistle at the mess hall for Xiomara, who paid in 64 iron pennies and a long story about the price of lamp oil. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 80 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short.

Entry 38, summer of year 9

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the old tunnels. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Zeph moved the brass lantern indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about who really won the regatta. Zeph found a copper pipe half-buried near the mess hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the mess hall: 86 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short.

Entry 39, spring of year 9

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the frozen moat; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Zeph for the password to the workshop. Zeph laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the old tunnels for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zeph spent the day counting stock at the frozen moat: 67 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short.

Entry 40, spring of year 9

Zeph repaired the brass lantern at the quartermaster's stores for Matthias, who paid in 72 iron pennies and a long story about who really won the regatta. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph found a coil of rope half-buried near the quartermaster's stores and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 41, spring of year 10

Zeph spent the day counting stock at the quartermaster's stores: 5 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. A dispute over the quarantine flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Zeph moved the clockwork bird indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the singing at the docks. Someone left a clockwork bird on the doorstep with no note. Zeph has a suspect and is probably right. Zeph repaired the brass lantern at the quartermaster's stores for Ulla, who paid in 22 iron pennies and a long story about whether the bridge will hold.

Entry 42, summer of year 10

The weather turned. Zeph moved the ledger indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the comet. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the east rampart; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the tax on doors. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 43, winter of year 10

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Zeph read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the mess hall. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zeph won 10 iron pennies on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 44, spring of year 10

Someone left a bolt of linen on the doorstep with no note. Zeph has a suspect and is probably right. Zeph found a clockwork bird half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the comet flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the signal tower; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph won 73 iron pennies on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 45, spring of year 10

Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the quartermaster's stores. Zeph pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zeph repaired the glass float at the quartermaster's stores for Bram, who paid in 82 iron pennies and a long story about the missing shipment. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Zeph and a neighbour outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zeph was hired to carry a hand bell from the quartermaster's stores to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded.